

The Renaissance beyond Italy

From Italy, largely through the advent of the printing press, the Renaissance slowly spread around Europe, emerging with varying interpretations. In northern Europe, France was the first country to absorb and translate the ideas. In the 1530s, architects Philibert de l'Orme (c.1510–70), Jean Bullant (1515–78) and Pierre Lescot (c.1510–78) visited Rome and took ideas back to France. L'Orme and Bullant worked on projects for the influential Queen of France Catherine de' Medici (1519–89), while Lescot took charge of building the Palais du Louvre for Francis I, turning it into a grand symmetrical palace from 1546. In England, Robert Smythson (1535–1614) built Hardwick Hall in Derbyshire (opposite). The Italian influence can be seen in the building's symmetry and classical-looking loggia, a double-storeyed open gallery above the front entrance. In Antwerp, the architect and sculptor Cornelis Floris (1514–75) was one of the many influenced by *L'Architettura*, published by Sebastiano Serlio (1475– c.1554) in 1537, and mixed Italian styles with Flemish traditional architecture.

